



WEEK 5 | SEXUAL ORIENTATION 性取向

ALINGGO, SHIUE LING, LEE

慈濟大學人類發展與心理學系教授

Learning Goals

01. Distinguish multiple forms of attraction (sexual, romantic, aesthetic, sensual, emotional) using precise academic terminology.
運用精準的學術術語，區分多種形式的吸引力（性吸引力、浪漫吸引力、美感吸引力、感官吸引力、情感吸引力）
02. Analyze how sexual orientation is socially constructed, regulated, and frequently misinterpreted through heteronormative assumptions.
分析性傾向是如何被社會建構、規制，以及異性戀規範假設如何導致性傾向被誤解的
03. Explain the structural relationship between gender norms and attraction without conflating gender identity, expression, and sexual orientation.
解釋性別規範與吸引力之間的結構性關係，避免混淆性別認同、性別表達和性取向

Theoretical Foundation: What Is Sexual Orientation?

Moving Beyond Labels

In public discourse, sexual orientation is often reduced to identity labels:

- Gay
- Lesbian
- Bisexual
- Straight



Theoretical Foundation: What Is Sexual Orientation?

Moving Beyond Labels

However, academically, orientation refers to:

A pattern of emotional, romantic, and/or sexual attraction over time.

It is not:

- a behavior
- a single experience
- a fashion trend
- a political position

It is a patterned direction of attraction.



Theoretical Foundation: What Is Sexual Orientation?

The Split Attraction Model

Attraction is not singular. It can include:

- Sexual attraction 性吸引力
- Romantic attraction 浪漫吸引力
- Aesthetic attraction 美感吸引力
- Sensual attraction 感官吸引力
- Emotional attraction 情感吸引力



Theoretical Foundation: What Is Sexual Orientation?

The Split Attraction Model

These may align — or may not align.

Example:

A person may...

Feel romantic attraction toward women

Feel sexual attraction toward multiple genders

Feel aesthetic attraction toward men

This complexity disrupts binary thinking. 這種複雜性打破了二元思維。

Theoretical Foundation: What Is Sexual Orientation?

Structural Concept: Heteronormativity

Heteronormativity 異性戀規範

The assumption that:

- heterosexuality is natural
- heterosexuality is normal
- heterosexuality is universal 普遍存在的
- heterosexual relationships are the social default 社會默認的

Theoretical Foundation: What Is Sexual Orientation?

Structural Concept: Heteronormativity

This assumption shapes:

- Media narratives 媒體敘事
- Family expectations 家庭期望
- School policies 學校政策
- Religious discourse 宗教話語
- Legal frameworks 法律框架

It is not neutral 中立.

It structures opportunity and legitimacy.



Theoretical Foundation: What Is Sexual Orientation?

Compulsory Heterosexuality 強制異性戀

Drawing from feminist theory, Compulsory heterosexuality describes:
借鑒女性主義理論，強制異性戀描述的是：

The social expectation that:

- women must desire men 女性必須渴望男性
- men must desire women 男性必須渴望女性



Theoretical Foundation: What Is Sexual Orientation?

Compulsory Heterosexuality 強制異性戀

Deviation 偏離 often triggers:

- correction 修正
- disbelief 懷疑
- fetishization 物化
- invisibility 隱形化
- moral panic 道德恐慌



Clarifying Conceptual Distinctions

Sexual Orientation性取向 is about:

direction of attraction

Gender Identity性別認同 is about:

internal sense of self

Gender Expression性別表達 is about:

external presentation

Social misunderstanding often conflates these three.



Clarifying Conceptual Distinctions

Example Misconceptions:

“You don’t look gay.”

“If you dress feminine, you must like men.”

“You dated a woman once, so you’re bisexual.”

These reflect:

- Expression conflated with orientation 將外表與性取向混淆
- Behavior conflated with identity 將行為與身分混淆
- Stereotype replacing structural understanding 刻板印象取代了對事物結構的理解

Social Misinterpretation and Erasure

Case Discussion Prompts

Small-group discussion:

- Why is bisexuality 雙性戀 often dismissed as 輕描淡寫地稱為 “confusion 困惑”?
- Why is asexuality 無性戀 frequently erased 忽視?
- Why are queer 酷兒 identities sometimes sexualized 性化?
- How does media representation simplify complex attraction?

Media and Orientation Representation

Students analyze:

- A film clip
- A short series excerpt
- A news headline
- A social media post

Analytical Questions:

- How is attraction represented?
- Is heterosexuality assumed as default?
- Is queer identity reduced to stereotype?
- Is complexity erased?



Structured Analytical Activity

Embrace | An Asexuality-Focused Animated Short Film

Theoretical Connection:

- Split Attraction Model 分裂性吸引力
- Erasure of asexual identities 無性戀身分的抹殺
- Compulsory sexuality 強制性的性行為



Structured Analytical Activity

Troye Sivan - YOUTH (Official Video)

Theoretical Connection:

- Misrecognition of attraction 對吸引力的誤判
- Distinction between romance and sexuality 浪漫與性慾的區分
- Structural misunderstanding of desire 慾望的結構性誤解



Structured Analytical Activity

Task:

1. Identify which forms of attraction are present. 辨識存在的各種吸引形式。
2. Explain why identity cannot be reduced to behavior. 解釋為什麼身分認同不能簡化為行為。
3. Identify one heteronormative assumption that might be imposed. 指出一種可能存在的異性戀規範假設。
4. Suggest one educational strategy to reduce misunderstanding. 提出一種減少誤解的教育策略。

Structured Analytical Activity

Mini Oral Report Template (90 seconds):

1. In this case, we observe...
2. The type(s) of attraction involved are...
3. A common misconception would be...
4. This reflects heteronormative bias because...
5. A structural response could be...



Advanced Concept Integration

Link to Week 4:

Gender norms regulate expression. 性別規範調節表達。

Heteronormativity regulates attraction. 異性戀規範調節吸引力。



Advanced Concept Integration

Both operate through:

- repetition
- silence
- moral panic
- media amplification
- family expectation

Structure organizes desire. 結構組織慾望。

Desire is not outside power. 慾望並非外在力量。



Homework

Submit:

- A short media example (link + timestamp)
- 4–6 sentence structural analysis using academic vocabulary
- One reflection:

“One assumption I used to have about sexual orientation was...”



Week 5

SEXUAL ORIENTATION, ATTRACTION, AND STRUCTURAL UNDERSTANDING

TCU, ALINGGO SHIUE-LING, LEE @2025

